



AP English Language and Composition

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADES 9–12 · FULL YEAR ·
ADVANCED PLACEMENT

~4¼ hrs per week · 50 min/day, M–F

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This page is drawn from the official College Board and Florida course frameworks rather than a built Optima course, so the specific readings, units, and activities scholars see will be set by the AP teacher and may vary between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

AP English Language and Composition is a college-level course in rhetoric: how writers use language to inform, persuade, and move readers. Scholars read widely in nonfiction — essays, speeches, journalism, memoir, and argument from many eras — and learn to analyze how those texts work, then to write that way themselves. The course earns one English credit toward graduation and culminates in the AP Exam each May; qualifying scores can earn college credit at most universities. Expect a genuine college workload: daily reading, frequent writing, and steady revision.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 Rhetorical Situation (all year)

Reading and writing with audience, purpose, and context in view: why a writer makes the choices they make.

3 Reasoning and Organization (all year)

Tracing a writer's line of reasoning and building one's own across a full essay.

5 The Three AP Essays (practiced all year)

Synthesis (an argument combining six or more provided sources), rhetorical analysis, and free-standing argument.

2 Claims and Evidence (all year)

Identifying, evaluating, and writing claims supported by well-chosen evidence from sources.

4 Style (all year)

How word choice, syntax, and tone create voice and serve persuasion.

6 The AP Exam (May)

45 multiple-choice questions plus the three essays in 3 hours 15 minutes; qualifying scores can earn college credit.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Close reading of nonfiction most days: essays, speeches, journalism, and visual arguments.
- Frequent writing in the three AP modes, both timed (exam conditions) and through full drafting and revision.
- Discussion and annotation that build the vocabulary of rhetoric: appeals, structure, diction, syntax, tone.
- Regular multiple-choice and essay practice with released AP materials as the exam approaches.

TIME COMMITMENT

250 minutes / week

≈ 50 minutes a day, Monday–Friday

- AP courses regularly require reading and writing beyond the scheduled class time.
- Timed-writing and exam-practice weeks intensify in the spring.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- A notebook for annotation, rhetorical vocabulary, and drafting.
- A College Board account and AP Exam registration (the school shares details during the year).
- Microsoft 365 and OneDrive (provided to every scholar) for process writing.

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting daily as a core course.